



Liszt at the age of 14.
Courtesy "The Musical Quarterly"

Franz Liszt, born in Raiding, Hungary, was a very delicate and sickly boy until he reached the age of six. Then, one day, while his father was playing a *Concerto* on the piano, little Franz came up beside him and implored him to repeat the last movement over and over again. "What would you like to be when you grow up?" asked his father, lighting his pipe. "That man there!" said the boy pointing to a picture of Beethoven. The next day his father began to give him lessons. Franz spent hours practising scales and made such rapid progress that he played in a concert by the time he was nine years old. The performance was so brilliant that everybody wanted to meet him and some of the nobles present raised funds to send him to Vienna for study with Czerny. Later "little Liszt" enjoyed a greater triumph for, when Beethoven heard him play, he was amazed by Franz's wonderful technique that he went to the stage, grasped the child, and kissed him on the forehead.

Because the little village of Raiding was rather isolated, it became a camping place for wandering gypsies, who, as they arrived in their wagons, would pitch their tents in the square. At night, amid the blaze of great bonfires, the men with violins and cymbals and the girls in brilliant coloured dresses, ear-rings, and necklaces, would dance and sing the rugged folk-tunes of Romany. Little Franz would drink in these weirdly abrupt rhythms and melodies which later became so evident in his famous *Hungarian Rhapsodies*.

Theme from Liebesträume No. 3

A Dream of Love

Andante

Liszt (1811-1886)

First system of musical notation. The treble staff contains a melody with a dotted half note, a quarter note, and a half note. The bass staff contains a bass line with a dotted half note, a quarter note, and a half note. The key signature is one sharp (F#). The tempo/mood is marked *mp*. There are fingerings 0, 4, 1, 2, 5 in the treble and 2, 1, 2, 1 in the bass.

Second system of musical notation. The treble staff contains a melody with a dotted half note, a quarter note, and a half note. The bass staff contains a bass line with a dotted half note, a quarter note, and a half note. The key signature is one sharp (F#). The tempo/mood is marked *poco a poco cresc.*. There are fingerings 3, 1, 5, 3, 1 in the treble and 1, 5, 1, 5 in the bass.

Third system of musical notation. The treble staff contains a melody with a dotted half note, a quarter note, and a half note. The bass staff contains a bass line with a dotted half note, a quarter note, and a half note. The key signature is one sharp (F#). The tempo/mood is marked *f rit.* and *mp*. There are fingerings 5, 3, 1, 2 in the treble and 1, 5, 1, 5 in the bass.

Fourth system of musical notation. The treble staff contains a melody with a dotted half note, a quarter note, and a half note. The bass staff contains a bass line with a dotted half note, a quarter note, and a half note. The key signature is one sharp (F#). The tempo/mood is marked *pp* and *poco rit.*. There are fingerings 5, 4, 1, 2, 3, 5, 4, 3, 2, 1 in the treble and 3, 5, 3, 2, 1, 5 in the bass.